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FREE GUIDE · 2026 EDITION

Becoming a Social Media Manager Without Experience

Social media management isn't just posting pretty pictures anymore. Across Nigeria, from boutiques in Lekki to restaurants in Abuja, business owners need someone who can grow their...



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Social media management isn't just posting pretty pictures anymore. Across Nigeria, from boutiques in Lekki to restaurants in Abuja, business owners need someone who can grow their pages and bring in real customers. Many are too busy running the business to do it themselves, and they will pay someone who can.

The best part? You don't need a marketing degree or years of office experience to get started. What you need is the right foundation, smart positioning and a simple system that lets you deliver results from day one.

If you're scrolling Instagram and TikTok every day anyway, why not get paid for it? But posting for yourself is very different from managing a business page. Let's get into it.

01 Step 1: Build Your Foundation Without Fake Experience

Master the core platforms first

Don't try to be an expert on every platform. Pick two or three and go deep:

- **Instagram + Facebook** (both owned by Meta, so your skills carry over)
- **TikTok** (if you're comfortable with video)
- **WhatsApp Business** (status, catalogues and broadcast lists; almost every Nigerian business uses it)
- **LinkedIn** (good for business clients like consultants and law firms, with less competition)

For each platform, learn how posts get shown to people, the best times to post for a Nigerian audience, and the types of content that do well. Spend 30 minutes a day studying top posts in different niches.

Create your own "portfolio" accounts

Start two or three themed pages in different niches:

- A local business page (small chops, a gym, a salon)
- A product page (ankara fashion, gadgets, shea butter skincare)
- A personal brand page (coaching, tutoring, career tips)

Post consistently for 30–60 days. Write down your follower growth, likes, comments and shares, and which posts worked best. This becomes your portfolio without needing client work.

Learn the tools of the trade

Download and get comfortable with:

- **Canva** (simple graphic design)
- **Meta Business Suite** (scheduling Facebook and Instagram posts, reading results, running ads)
- **Buffer or Later** (scheduling across platforms; free plans exist, paid plans are billed in US dollars)
- **Google Analytics** (seeing how many people visit a website from social media)

Most have free versions, which are perfect for learning. Spend a week on each tool creating sample posts and campaigns.

02 Step 2: Position Yourself as the Solution, Not a Beginner

The "fresh perspective" angle

Instead of hiding your inexperience, flip it. Present yourself as someone who understands social media today because you live in it daily. Many older agencies struggle with TikTok trends and Instagram Reels, but you don't.

Your promise: "I help businesses reach customers using the social media methods that actually work today."

Start with local service businesses

Restaurants, gyms, salons and event planners need social media but often don't have the time or know-how. They're perfect first clients because:

- Results are easy to see (followers, comments, DMs, walk-ins, orders)
- They value personal, local connections
- They're less likely to expect agency-level experience
- Word of mouth spreads fast in local communities and estates

Create your first case study

Offer to manage one local business's pages free for 30 days. For example, Halima in Kano could run the Instagram for a nearby perfume oil shop. Write down everything:

- Follower growth
- Increases in likes, comments and shares
- Posts that did best
- Any increase in calls, WhatsApp messages, visits or sales

This becomes the proof that you can deliver results, even without traditional experience.

03 Step 3: Your Client-Getting System and Success Toolkit

The outreach formula that works

Skip the generic "I can help your social media" messages. Instead, do quick checks of local businesses' pages and find two or three specific things to improve:

- "I noticed your last 5 Instagram posts got under 10 likes each. I have ideas for posts that could get you much more engagement."
- "You haven't posted on your Facebook page in 3 weeks. I can help you stay consistent with a content calendar."

Then offer a free 15–minute call or WhatsApp chat to discuss solutions.

Pricing your services right

Start with monthly packages, not hourly rates. These are example amounts; check what managers charge in your city:

- **Basic package** (about ₦80,000/month): 12 posts, replying to comments and messages, simple report
- **Growth package** (about ₦150,000/month): 20 posts, stories, small ad campaigns, monthly strategy call
- **Premium package** (about ₦250,000/month and up): full content creation, ads management, detailed reporting

Price based on the value you deliver, not the time spent. A post that brings in 10 new customers is worth far more than the 20 minutes it took to make. Ask for payment upfront by bank transfer or a Paystack payment link.

Your 90-day success plan

Days 1–30: Build portfolio pages, learn the tools, create your first case study.

Days 31–60: Start outreach, land your first two or three clients, improve your process.

Days 61–90: Grow to five to eight clients, raise your prices, put everything into a system. Consider registering a business name with the CAC so bigger companies can pay you as a business.

Starter toolkit for social media success

Here's everything you need to start landing clients right away:

1. Content creation templates

- Instagram carousel templates for different industries
- Facebook post templates that get people talking
- WhatsApp status and broadcast templates
- Story templates for daily content

2. Client onboarding package

- Brand questionnaire to understand their business
- Process for approving posts before they go out
- Monthly reporting template
- Plan for handling bad reviews or angry comments

3. Free tools and resources list

- Canva templates for every industry
- Unsplash for free photos
- Later for scheduling (free plan)
- Meta Business Suite for results

4. Outreach message templates

- First contact message
- Follow-up messages
- Proposal template
- Contract template

5. Pricing calculator: A simple Google Sheet to work out monthly packages based on what you deliver and local rates.

Tip: Many clients want to sell online, not just post. Point them to Shopinbos, where Rex builds their store, so their posts link to a place customers can pay.

04 Ready to Start Your Social Media Management Career?

The difference between people who think about becoming social media managers and those who actually do it? Having the right system and tools from day one.

Download our Complete Social Media Manager Starter Kit, including client templates, outreach scripts and step-by-step guides to land your first paying client.

Get Your Starter Kit Now

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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